Spot the Misleading Chart

Student worksheet

Name:	Class:	Date:

A good chart makes **one point**, clearly and honestly. Use this sheet with the *Good Charts vs Bad Charts* website.

Part 1: Match each mistake to its rule

Write the letter of the rule that fixes each mistake.

Mistake	Letter	Rule
1. Bar chart axis starting above zero		**A.** Space dates by how much time really passed.
2. Two y-axes stretched to match		**B.** Show the trend, not the noise.
3. Joining every poll with a line		**C.** Bar charts always start at zero.
4. Colour suggesting a group that isn't there		**D.** Up on the chart should mean more.
5. Pie chart with nine slices		**E.** Use sorted bars to compare many parts.
6. Upside-down y-axis		**F.** Show each period, not the total so far.
7. Running total hiding a drop		**G.** A new colour should mean a new group.
8. Uneven gaps between dates		**H.** Be suspicious when two lines match perfectly.

Part 2: Take the quiz

Do the quiz on the website. Write your score, then the rule you found hardest and why.

My score: out of 8
Hardest rule and why:

Part 3: Find a chart in the real world

Find a chart in a news site, social media post, ad or textbook. Answer the 5 questions about it.

Where I found it (website, link or page):
What is the chart about?

Question	What I noticed
Where does the axis start? Bars should start at zero, or their lengths lie.	
Is there more than one axis? Two axes can be stretched to make any two lines look connected.	
What do the colours mean? A new colour should mean a new group, nothing else.	
Is it a real change or just noise? Bumpy data needs a trend line, not a zig-zag.	
What is the one point? If you can't say it in one sentence, the chart is too busy.	

Verdict (tick one): [ ] Good chart [ ] Confusing [ ] Hides the point [ ] Misleading
How would you fix it? Describe or sketch a better version.